

A Word in Defense of Schleiermacher's Theological Method

Author(s): Van A. Harvey

Source: *The Journal of Religion*, Jul., 1962, Vol. 42, No. 3 (Jul., 1962), pp. 151-170

Published by: The University of Chicago Press

Stable URL: <https://www.jstor.org/stable/1201318>

JSTOR is a not-for-profit service that helps scholars, researchers, and students discover, use, and build upon a wide range of content in a trusted digital archive. We use information technology and tools to increase productivity and facilitate new forms of scholarship. For more information about JSTOR, please contact support@jstor.org.

Your use of the JSTOR archive indicates your acceptance of the Terms & Conditions of Use, available at <https://about.jstor.org/terms>



The University of Chicago Press is collaborating with JSTOR to digitize, preserve and extend access to *The Journal of Religion*

JSTOR

THE JOURNAL OF RELIGION

Volume XLII

JULY 1962

Number 3

A WORD IN DEFENSE OF SCHLEIERMACHER'S THEOLOGICAL METHOD

VAN A. HARVEY*

I

THE charitable tone of Karl Barth's essay of 1952 on Schleiermacher¹ contrasts sharply with the stridency of his earlier criticism. In 1922, Barth wrote:

With all due respect to the genius shown in his work, I can *not* consider Schleiermacher a good teacher in the realm of theology because, so far as I can see, he is disastrously dim-sighted in regard to the fact that man as man is not only in *need* but beyond all hope of saving himself; that the whole of so-called religion, and not least the Christian religion, *shares* in this need; and that one can *not* speak of God simply by speaking of man in a loud voice.²

Thirty years later, Barth stresses what the church should admire in and learn from Schleiermacher: his monumental achievements in philosophy, his extraordinary ability to think dogmatically,

and, most of all, his singular devotion to his vocation as theologian and man in the pulpit. Against those who dance on Schleiermacher's grave, Barth cautions: "Anyone who has never loved here and is not in a position to love again and again may not hate here either."³

Barth's charity, to be sure, does not prevent him from criticizing Schleiermacher; now, as before, he believes that a firm, though kindlier, "*Nein*" must be placed at the conclusion of Schleiermacher's entire enterprise. But the later Barth wishes to honor the achievement and sincerity of his nineteenth-century predecessor and to caution the zealots of the twentieth century not to dismiss Schleiermacher arrogantly from the church or to think that nothing could be learned from him. Schleiermacher's achievement was so great, Barth points out, that the entire nineteenth century may be said to have been his century; indeed, it may well yet appear that the twentieth is his also. "Nobody can say whether we have really overcome his influence, or whether we are still at heart children of his age, despite all the protest against him. . . ."⁴ His work cannot be overcome, therefore, by means of a mere caviling criticism of detail; only a monumental counter-achievement can prevail against it.

* The author received a B.A. degree as a Phi Beta Kappa from Occidental College in 1948 and B.D. and Ph.D. degrees from Yale University. Formerly assistant professor in the Department of Religion at Princeton University, he took the position he now holds at Perkins School of Theology, Southern Methodist University, in 1958. Previous to this he has published articles in *Religion in Life*, *Church History*, *Theology Today*, the *Journal of Religion*, and most recently, in collaboration with his colleague Schubert M. Ogden, *Zeitschrift für Theologie und Kirche*. During the past academic year he was engaged in research at the University of Marburg, Germany.

Barth modestly adds the judgment that the man who can claim to measure himself against Schleiermacher has not yet appeared—a judgment, however, that has not prevented other commentators from investing Barth with the necessary stature.

Barth apparently believes, as I shall later show, that Rudolf Bultmann's theological method and its widespread influence confirms that too many are still at heart children of Schleiermacher's age. Barth had noted the similarity between Bultmann and Schleiermacher as early as the first volume of his dogmatics, where he pointed out that Bultmann's "anthropologization of theology" is fundamentally a "piece of liberalism" (*ein Stück Liberalismus*), even though the colors of existentialism flying over the vessel tend to conceal its true cargo.⁵ If Barth's earlier work was a conscious attempt to overcome Schleiermacher, one of his later volumes, therefore, is quite consistently to be regarded as an "intensive, but on the whole, quiet debate with Rudolf Bultmann."⁶

Barth and his followers interpret the fundamental issue between themselves and the Schleiermacher-Bultmann tradition to be the conception of theology: Is theology to be understood as the development of an objective knowledge of the Triune God who has revealed his intrinsic nature in Jesus Christ? Or is it to be viewed as an attempt merely to conceptualize what is given in the believer's self-consciousness, thereby renouncing all claim to speak of God as he is in himself and apart from faith? The Barthians maintain that the latter view, which argues that God is known only in relation to the believer, mistakenly identifies statements about God

with statements about the self. This mistake is quite clearly evident in Schleiermacher's work, as this sentence taken from the *Glaubenslehre* indicates: "All attributes which we ascribe to God are to be taken as denoting not something special in God, but only something special in the manner in which the feeling of absolute dependence is to be related to Him."⁷ This view, the accusation continues, surrenders any possibility of an objective knowledge of God; it is a kind of theological agnosticism. Furthermore, it destroys the idea of God's freedom in relation to the world, his transcendence, because the word "God" merely denotes the static determinant postulated as the other "objective" pole of the psychological condition called faith.⁸

The defenders of the relational view argue that the Barthian view represents a "positivism of revelation,"⁹ that is, certain Christian doctrines, if not given in revelation, are thought to be immediate inferences from it. This objectivism is unconvincing and irrelevant: unconvincing because there are no criteria of verifiability or of meaning except the appeal to revelation; irrelevant because, as in the case of Barth's doctrine of the Trinity, there is no intrinsic connection between this doctrine and the idea of God's freedom which he claims this doctrine preserves and protects. Against the accusation of the objectivists, the relationalist maintains that God's revelation is not directed to what Bushnell called "the scientific intellect." Revelation is "encounter" and resists formulation in speculative categories. God's freedom is the irreducible "other-ness" of the One who is acknowledged in faith.

Primarily, the purpose of this essay is to explore the relationship between

Schleiermacher's method and his doctrine of God. Secondly, the aim is to cast some light upon the debate briefly described above. The guiding question is this: Are the usual errors attributed to Schleiermacher—his alleged rejection of the transcendence of God (somewhat crudely described as his "pantheism"), his subjectivism, and his agnosticism—necessary consequences of his method? Or may they be attributed to other causes? The secondary question is this: If these errors can be shown to be the results of other causes and not the direct consequences of his critical method, then do we need a monumental counter-achievement in method as Barth claims? Or should we call for a refinement and extension of Schleiermacher's method? Perhaps his theological program may be interpreted as an *unfulfilled possibility* and not as an accomplishment forever witnessing to the errors following from his methodological starting point.

H. Richard Niebuhr in his *Meaning of Revelation* not only supports the validity of our leading question but provides a useful hint concerning the direction one might look for the reasons for Schleiermacher's errors. The importance of Schleiermacher and Ritschl, he suggests, lies in their understanding that "theology needed to confess its limitations; it could not describe God as he is in himself but only God in human experience. . . ." ¹⁰ Both realized that "it was not the business of theology to transcend its limits as a theology of faith. . . . God and faith belong together." ¹¹ If there was a defect in Schleiermacher's theology, Niebuhr concludes, it consisted not in his critical method but in "an inconsistency in his method which brought fateful consequences with it." ¹² One such consequence was Schleier-

macher's focusing of attention on faith rather than on the object of faith.

Niebuhr's observation is interesting because it suggests that Schleiermacher's error lay not in his stated method but in his failure to employ it *consistently*. This inconsistency and its effects so far as the idea of God's freedom is concerned are the objects of my inquiry. In order to explore this territory, I must first traverse some more or less familiar ground: Schleiermacher's theory of the self and his description of the religious consciousness. This is necessary to make clear the relationship between the believer's consciousness and what Schleiermacher called the divine causality (*die göttliche Ursachlichkeit*). This latter notion is, I believe, the central one in the *Glaubenslehre*, and it contains the key to his method, his doctrines, and his errors.

II

One of the basic motifs running through the thought of both Luther and Calvin is this: Theological affirmations are not descriptions of God as he is in and for himself, but of God as he is given to faith. The knowledge of God, wrote Calvin, has not to do with "cold and frivolous" speculations on the essence of God but with that saving knowledge concerning God's will and disposition toward us. It is to "know what is agreeable to his character." ¹³ Since we do not know what God is, the fundamental categories of theology are not those of essence and attribute so much as they are of Law and Gospel and of the works of the Son and the Holy Spirit. One might argue that Schleiermacher's intention was the same as that of the Reformers were it not that the relationship between God and

the believer seems to have acquired such a different tone and character in Schleiermacher's work by virtue of his use of such forms as "consciousness," "piety," and "feeling," terms which cannot be easily substituted for what the Reformers meant by "faith." Yet there is a fundamental and underlying affinity: Speech about God is limited to his effects upon (benefits to) the believer, his relation to faith. This is expressed in this characteristic statement by Schleiermacher:

We have only to do with the God-consciousness given in our self-consciousness along with our consciousness of the world; hence we have no formula for the being of God in Himself as distinct from the being of God in the world, and should have to borrow any such formula from speculation, and so prove ourselves disloyal to the character of the discipline at which we are working.¹⁴

The same relational view of dogmatic statements is stressed in the following:

All propositions which the system of Christian doctrine has to establish can be regarded either as descriptions of human states, or as conceptions of divine attributes and modes of action, or as utterances regarding the constitution of the world; and all three forms have always subsisted alongside of each other.¹⁵

To be sure, Schleiermacher further argues that an ideal system would reduce the latter two types of propositions to the former,¹⁶ and, to this extent, he legitimately deserves the usual criticism that he was subjectivistic. This statement, however, scarcely does justice to his actual *practice*, and it must be interpreted primarily in the light of it. Actually, Schleiermacher makes clear that the religious consciousness is always a consciousness *of* something *extra nos*. It would be impossible to limit dogmatics to a description of human states apart from whatever it is that

conditions them. The form of the subjective pole (consciousness) is unintelligible without reference to the objective pole (the divine causality). The key to understanding Schleiermacher's thought is the relationship of consciousness to that which conditions it. I must turn, therefore, to a discussion of Schleiermacher's theory of the religious consciousness and of its relation to the divine causality.

Schleiermacher, at one important point in the *Glaubenslehre*, distinguishes between three levels of consciousness: the animal-like, the sensibly-determined, and the religious.¹⁷ The lowest, or animal-like, stage is a state of unresolved confusion in which no distinction between self and other has yet arisen. It may be compared to a dream-like existence or to the consciousness of a child before it has learned language and the ability to differentiate between subject and object. The second, or sensibly-determined, sphere is that in which the antithesis between self and other, subject and object, has made its appearance. This stage is necessarily, therefore, an annulment of the previous unself-conscious stage. The third level is the highest, but its emergence *does not cancel* the second stage as the second does the first; rather, the third is awakened by and exists only in and through the second level, although it must be distinguished from it. If the sensible self-consciousness is a consciousness of being-with, being affected by and affecting others, the religious consciousness is an accompanying awareness of participating in finite being as such, but in a way that all antithesis between one individual and another is canceled. Only then can one

speak of the feeling of absolute dependence.¹⁸

In addition to the categories denoting the three levels of consciousness, Schleiermacher employs two others: receptivity and activity. Every self-consciousness, he wrote, contains two elements, a "self-caused" (*sichselbstsetzen*) and a "non-self-caused" (*sichselbstnichtso-gesetzhaben*), a "being" (*Sein*) and a "by-some-means-having-come-to-be" (*Irgendwiegewordensein*).¹⁹ The self-caused element is our spontaneous ability to affect others, our freedom; the non-self-caused element is what has come to be by virtue of the actions of others upon us, our dependence. Although both elements enable one to define human conscious existence as existence-with-others, the latter (the receptive element) is particularly stressed by Schleiermacher as presupposing "something outside of the Ego which is the source of the particular determination of it and without which the self-consciousness would not be precisely what it is."²⁰ Every sensible consciousness, when analyzed, points beyond itself to that which accounts for what the self now is, although, it must be added, it cannot *fully* account for the state of the self because the self is also partially free.

The feeling of freedom and the feeling of dependence, which correspond to these two aspects of the self, alternate in strength, depending upon the scope or range of the consciousness. When consciousness is determined by its relation to any existing finite object, such as a tool, the feeling of freedom will predominate and the feeling of dependence will recede. When consciousness is determined by its relation to a larger whole, such as one's country, the feel-

ing of freedom will be less and the feeling of dependence will become greater. If one were to consider his relation to the world as a whole, the totality of receptive and active subjects and objects, the feeling of dependence would be at a maximum and the feeling of freedom at a minimum, although even here some freedom would remain, albeit greatly diminished. If, however, one were to *identify* himself with finite existence as such, and to become aware not only that his freedom and dependence but even the entire reciprocating system of nature is contingent, then there would arise a new determination of the consciousness, the feeling of absolute dependence. Here the self does not set itself over against any other *individual* being, but, on the contrary, all antithesis between one individual and another is done away.²¹ The word "God," as Schleiermacher uses it, signifies the whence (*Woher*) of *both* our receptive and active existence, "simply that which is co-determinant in this feeling and to which we trace our being in such a state; and any further content of the idea must be evolved out of this fundamental import assigned to it."²²

It is important to stress that this feeling of absolute dependence could neither come to be nor continue to exist apart from the sensible self-consciousness with its relative feeling of freedom and dependence. As I have noted above, the feeling of absolute dependence is only awakened when the sensible self-consciousness extends its angle of vision, so to speak, to include the whole of contingent nature and then asks the question of the Source of this whole. Therefore the God-consciousness exists only in and through the consciousness of being a member of a mutually condi-

tioned but given "system of nature."²³ On the other hand, these two stages of consciousness stand in reciprocal relationship to each other; the color and tone of the religious self-consciousness is profoundly influenced by the sensible self-consciousness, while the religious self-consciousness, in turn, attaches itself to the specific feelings of the sensible self-consciousness conditioned by the realm of subject and object and, by doing so, defines them as religious.

In his clarification of this, Schleiermacher notes that the sensible self-consciousness (that which relates the self to others, to history, and the world) is made up of a series of moments that differ in content depending upon the data; thus, joy, sorrow, pain, pleasure, and the like. This is true because our own activity as selves is temporal, and the influence upon us by other persons and objects (the causal nexus) is also temporal. But the feeling of absolute dependence, being in itself always self-identical, does not evoke such a series of distinguishable moments and could not unless it were to enter into relation with such a series. In fact, unless the feeling of absolute dependence were bound to the sensible realm, it could not come into consciousness at all and would simply accompany the sensible self-consciousness monotonously and without relation to the coloration of our emotional life, which is due to our concrete relations in the sensible (subject-object) realm. Experience reveals, however, that our religious feeling is colored by our temporal relations, and this demonstrates that the feeling of absolute dependence is always a constituent factor in any given moment of consciousness, which consists also of a partial feeling of freedom and dependence.

By being such a constituent, it becomes a *religious* emotion of a certain definite character in one moment (depending upon the datum of the sensible self-consciousness) and a religious emotion of a different sort in another moment; "the difference arises simply from the fact that it becomes a different moment when it goes along with a different determination of the self-consciousness."²⁴

In this fashion, Schleiermacher attempts to account for the peculiar form that piety (the feeling of absolute dependence) takes in different religions. All religions may be said to presuppose abstractly the feeling of absolute dependence, but this feeling is given a quite different form and pathos in each religion by virtue of the determinations of the sensible self-consciousness. The unity of a religious community consists in these concrete religious feelings, not in the feeling of absolute dependence as such. Therefore, Schleiermacher is able to say that this feeling of absolute dependence is *presupposed* in every concrete religious affection and yet, on the other hand, resists any attempt to make it the basis for a natural theology or for the union of religions.²⁵ There is no such thing as religion, there are only religions. There is no feeling of absolute dependence as such existing by itself; there are only concrete religious affections given their peculiar form by the union of the sensible and the religious self-consciousness. This is also the reason why Schleiermacher insists on the importance of history, especially for the Christian religion. It is through history that the sensible self-consciousness stamps its indelible character on the religious affections:

In every religious affection, however much its special contents may predominate, the God-

consciousness must be present and cannot be neutralized by anything else, so that there can be no relation to Christ which does not contain also a relation to God. At the same time, we also assert that this God-consciousness, as it is here described, does not constitute by itself alone an actual moment in religious experience, but always in connexion with other particular determinations; so that this God-consciousness maintains its identity through its particular moments in all manifestations of Christian piety, just as in life generally the self-consciousness of an individual does in the different moments of his existence.²⁶

It follows that God is encountered *only* in his action in the world. Theology is not concerned with God's internal nature but rather with the way he is given to the self through its history. All divine attributes, therefore, may be exhibited either as modes of the divine action (or causality), and "God" and the "absolute causality" may be used interchangeably.

In the light of this brief clarification of Schleiermacher's theory of consciousness, one can imagine how he would have responded to the accusation that he has delivered religious knowledge over to the vagaries of feeling. The anxiety lurking behind this criticism is that "feeling," as we now tend to employ this word, is ephemeral and has little to do with the intrinsic nature of the objects about which we feel; this, in turn, raises the question whether our feelings refer to an objective reality, whether they provide us with a clue to the relationship of this reality to us. Schleiermacher, especially in the *Reden*, does not put our anxiety in this regard to rest. There he writes that doctrines "are a knowledge about feeling, and in no way an immediate knowledge about the operations of the Universe, that gave rise to the feeling."²⁷

Professor Richard Brandt argues

that there is a basic equivocation in Schleiermacher's use of the word "consciousness" (*Bewusstsein*). He used the term, Brandt writes,

sometimes to refer to a noncognitive "feeling" . . . and sometimes to refer to an act analogous to belief, that is to refer to a consciousness of something, such as the consciousness of being a finite object conditioned by God. This equivocation appears to go far to lighten his task of explaining how doctrines can be the expression of feeling. For doctrines (even when taken literally) can be an expression of "consciousness" when he is using the word in its intentional sense, and they can also be said to be an expression of feeling . . . , for the word is also used in a non-intentional sense. The plausibility of his argument seems to depend upon his shifting back and forth from one sense to another.²⁸

There is some justice in this criticism, but it is not as serious as one might suppose. Schleiermacher, like Kant, conceived of God as the transcendental ground of knowledge and action and not, properly speaking, an object of knowledge. Since he believed this could be shown to be true, the awareness of this ground would have to be mediated to the self through some other "organ" or "faculty" than the reason.²⁹ So far as Schleiermacher was concerned, feeling was just such a "faculty." The term "faculty" is misleading, however, because he did not interpret feeling as residing in one organ alongside of others; rather he believed feeling constitutes the unity of the self and underlies and penetrates both intellect and will. Moreover, feeling surely is not ephemeral, nor does it vary from person to person. It is "a universal element of life" and constitutes the uniqueness of human nature.

This interpretation is supported by a reading of Schleiermacher's *Dialektik*, a series of lecture notes on epistemology set down over a period extending from

1811 to 1831.³⁰ Although these cryptic and fragmentary notes pose difficult textual and interpretative problems, they make clear why Schleiermacher, although he thought it confusing to speak of God as an object of knowledge, could still interpret feeling as analogous to an act of belief in the sense of referring to a transcendental reality. In a highly technical portion dedicated to a transcendental deduction of the presuppositions of knowledge, Schleiermacher argues that all knowledge presupposes a transcendental ground as the basis for the unity between thought and being, the ideal and the real. This transcendental ground is the "idea of Being-in-itself under two antithetical and related kinds of forms and modes, the Ideal and the Real, as the condition of the reality of knowledge."³¹ Since this transcendental being was, according to Schleiermacher's logic, the presupposition of all judgment and predication, it could not itself be an object of such judgment and predication. It is at once a limit of thought and the basic presupposition of thought. There is some question whether this idea of "Being-in-itself" is to be identified with God;³² but even if God is something beyond "Being-in-itself," it is clear why Schleiermacher thought it inappropriate to talk about God as if he were an object of knowledge. Since God cannot be known (as he explicitly stated in the *Glaubenslehre*), the feeling of absolute dependence is "the only way in which, in general, our own being and the infinite being of God can be one in self-consciousness."³³

That to which feeling refers is the absolute causality (or God) working in and through what Schleiermacher calls the universal nature-system or world. God acts upon and determines the con-

sciousness in and through the system of secondary causes. The self is related to this causal nexus by means of the sensible self-consciousness and, beyond that, to the ground of this causal nexus by means of the religious self-consciousness. There is no religious apprehension until there is an awareness of the contingency of the entire system of reciprocating agents, although the quality of the religious apprehension is determined by the character of the feelings relating us to other beings *within* that system. This does not mean, as I shall show later, that in Schleiermacher's view God is identical with the world, but that the awareness of God is impossible without the sense of being a reciprocal part of the causal nexus.³⁴

Our knowledge of God is first realized with our intuition of the world. As soon as there is a trace of the latter, there exist characteristics of the former. To the degree that the intuition of the world is defective, the idea of God will remain mythical.³⁵

This view will be disturbing to those who hold a more personalistic idea of God, but it is quite inappropriate to label it, as Emil Brunner does, a non-historical mysticism.³⁶ As Brandt observes, all that could be meant by the vague term mysticism in this case is that God is believed to be the ultimate reality in and behind every historical event. It was Schleiermacher's way of interpreting history as providence.

The equivalence of divine causality with the whole content of the finite enables every act to excite the religious consciousness, every act, that is, in which we take up into ourselves a part of the natural order or identify ourselves with such a part, every moment of our self-consciousness as it extends over the whole world. And thus, whenever a person either moves or is moved, he is also drawn to a conscious apprehension of the power of the

Highest directly near to him in all finite causality.³⁷

being neither separated from the other nor limited by it.³⁹

Schleiermacher believed he was only restating in his own terms what Luther and Calvin had expressed in different language. Luther, it is often overlooked, viewed the created world as occupying a sort of mediatorial position between God and man. He spoke about every creature as a mask of deity and as containing Christ, the Word of God.³⁸ For Luther, as for Calvin, the problem was to believe that creation was, in fact, grace and not the work of an enemy who intends to slay us. Although Schleiermacher's view is admittedly more aesthetic and less prophetic, more tinged with pathos than with drama, one can still recognize here the effort to interpret creation as providence and as the outpouring of a benevolent spirit. It is hardly valid to object that Schleiermacher's feeling of absolute dependence does not tell one whether the character of the ground of being can be described as love or wisdom; Schleiermacher, like Luther and Calvin, believed that this belief was a specifically Christian one, which is to say, made possible only by virtue of Jesus Christ. The feeling of absolute dependence in itself is only the presupposition of the Christian self-consciousness and is not that from which the Christian can derive his doctrines of the divine love and wisdom. With this limitation in mind, Schleiermacher was historically correct, at least, when he noted:

It has been always acknowledged by the strictest dogmaticians that divine preservation, as the absolute dependence of all events and changes on God, and natural causation, as the complete determination of all events by the universal nexus, are one and the same thing simply from different points of view, the one

III

Schleiermacher's theological intent was to say nothing about God or the world that could not be extrapolated from the believer's consciousness. The issue now to be considered is how consistently he realized this intent. It is impossible to answer this question fully without undertaking an analysis of his treatment of all the Christian doctrines. For our present purposes, however, it is enough to focus on the doctrine of God as expounded in connection with the feeling of absolute dependence. The problem is whether Schleiermacher's unsatisfactory treatment of the freedom of God results from his method or is due to other factors not intrinsically related to that method.

The most striking characteristic of Schleiermacher's treatment of the attributes of God is that they are discussed in widely separated parts of the *Glaubenslehre*. The divine attributes of eternity, omnipresence, omnipotence, and omniscience are expounded in the earliest section treating the feeling of absolute dependence abstractly considered, which is to say as a presupposition of Christian dogmatics. The attributes of holiness and justice are discussed some one hundred and fifty pages later in the section having to do with the Christian consciousness as determined by the feeling of sin. Finally, the divine attributes of love and wisdom are not discussed until the end of the *Glaubenslehre* where the divine causality is interpreted as redemption.

Karl Barth has condemned this procedure as an "utterly catastrophic dissolution and destruction of the whole

conception of God."⁴⁰ It can hardly be denied that the procedure is a curious one. It is especially regrettable, since Schleiermacher's method seemed to offer the promise of a genuinely confessional and relational theology in which it would be artificial to separate feelings about God considered abstractly from feelings mediated through and stamped by the character of one's historical relationships. The interpenetration of the religious self-consciousness and the sensible self-consciousness made it possible, if not imperative, to begin with the concrete images and symbols of the faith of a definite religious community. Schleiermacher no sooner laid the foundations for such a program than he reverted to his earlier Romantic pattern of thought that celebrated the common features of religion at the expense of the historical and concrete.

However regrettable Schleiermacher's procedure may be, is Barth's criticism a decisive one? Even if in concrete existence one could not separate an abstract presupposition of consciousness from its actual content, would it follow that one could not distinguish between them for theoretical purposes? A metaphysician may not find essence and existence separable in experience, but he may find the distinction useful for intellectual work. Likewise a theologian may prefer to discuss the concept of sin apart from the concept of grace, even though he may believe that the one cannot arise in consciousness without the other.

The fact that Schleiermacher discusses the attributes of God in widely separated sections of the *Glaubenslehre* is not in itself, therefore, a decisive criticism, however one may lament the

procedure. But the fact that he does this may tempt the reader to pay less attention than he should to a far more important question: Are the attributes, which are scattered over the work, consistent with one another and if not, why not? More particularly, are the attributes allegedly abstracted from the feeling of absolute dependence (eternity, omnipresence, omnipotence, omniscience) compatible with those abstracted from the Christian consciousness of redemption (love and wisdom)? Does Schleiermacher accommodate the attributes of God given in revelation to those given in the general religious self-consciousness? Or are the latter corrected by the former?

I do not intend here to seek to demonstrate the inconsistency between the two sets of attributes as interpreted by Schleiermacher—although I believe it can be done—but to show that his interpretation of the classical metaphysical attributes is incompatible with his critical method and that certain errors are to be accounted for only by this fact. I will attempt to demonstrate that Schleiermacher in two important places makes speculative judgments of a dubious sort which violate his methodological principles. Furthermore, these judgments have the effect of seriously vitiating, if not destroying, the idea of God's transcendence, and, to this extent, account for the somewhat crude charge of pantheism frequently leveled at him.

It will be remembered that in addition to the categories designating the three levels of consciousness, Schleiermacher employs another set of distinctions, receptivity and activity. These two elements are present regardless of the scope of the consciousness, although

the feeling of dependence may predominate at some times while the feeling of freedom predominates at others. Only when the self identifies itself with finite existence as such, and asks what the whole is contingent on, does the feeling of absolute dependence arise. Here the self is aware of having both its freedom and dependence given to it. In this state of consciousness, there remains *no* sense of freedom, if by this one means the ability to exercise a counterinfluence on the source of our existence.⁴¹ This source can in no sense be thought of as standing in a reciprocal relationship of giving and taking. If we are absolutely dependent, the source is absolutely independent of us.

But, it may be asked, does Schleiermacher's conclusion actually follow from his analysis of the self-consciousness? Is there anything in the feeling of absolute contingency necessitating the judgment that the source upon which we are dependent stands in no sort of reciprocal relationship to the dependent consciousness of which it is the source? The latter question is rhetorical and must, I believe, be answered in the negative. An analysis of the religious self-consciousness permits one to say only that the subject, so far as both its relative freedom and dependence are concerned, is contingent; it does not permit a definite claim about the being upon which the subject is dependent. Because our freedom is given, we cannot correctly conclude that our freedom is not genuine or that we exercise no counterinfluence on its origin. Schleiermacher, at this point, simply assumes without convincing argument the validity of the classical formulation of God as the unconditioned origin of being. Whether this formulation is meta-

physically adequate or not is not now the question; the point at issue is whether such a concept can be derived from an analysis of the believer's self-consciousness. On Schleiermacher's own principles, it cannot, for the feeling of absolute dependence does not tell us about God in himself but only that the creature is absolutely contingent.

The error depends upon confusing two propositions: "The self, with its relative freedom and dependence, is contingent," and "that upon which the self is contingent is in no way affected by the self." These two propositions are not, however, identical. As Charles Hartshorne has frequently pointed out, the creature may be absolutely dependent in the sense of having both its relative freedom and dependence given to it, but this is not incompatible with the further assertion that the Creator may in some respects be influenced by what he has created.⁴² To be more specific, the knowledge the Creator has of the creation is a knowledge *of* something, and, to this degree, the Creator is influenced by (dependent upon?) what he knows, unless the word "knowledge" is to be used in a fundamentally different (non-analogous) sense than we normally use it. Schleiermacher, as we shall soon see, does in fact use the term in such a different sense, so different that it is questionable whether the term has any clear meaning at all. The upshot is that the feeling of absolute dependence of the creature was subtly and illicitly converted into a statement about the absolute independence of the Creator.

This error was compounded by still another of the same formal type, that is, a transgression of the stated limits of his method. This occurs in the interest-

ing section devoted to a discussion of the attributes of God as extrapolated from the feeling of absolute dependence. In this section Schleiermacher pursues with rigor his fundamental thesis that statements about the divine attributes are actually statements about the divine causality manifested in the world. This view, together with some of the extreme utterances to be found in his *Reden*, has been the basis for the charge that his theology is pantheistic or, more accurately (with Barth), that he identified the power of God with the general power at work in the world.⁴³ There is some justice in the charge, even though Schleiermacher maintains that the ideas of God and world not only are distinct in thought but express different contents of feeling:

We recognize in our self-consciousness an awareness of the world, but it is different from the awareness of God in the same self-consciousness. . . . To be one with the world in self-consciousness is nothing else than being conscious that we are a living part of this whole; and this cannot possibly be a consciousness of absolute dependence. . . .

The feeling of absolute dependence, accordingly, is not to be explained as an awareness of the world's existence, but only as an awareness of the existence of God, as the absolute undivided unity.⁴⁴

Schleiermacher's views on the relationship of God to the world may not be fully satisfactory. But some unnecessary confusion in this respect will be avoided if it is never forgotten that Schleiermacher derives the content of the ideas from the way they function in our consciousness. The concept of the world is a limiting idea standing at the edge of all possible experience. The idea of God refers to the ground of both experience and reality. Schleiermacher's

position is stated rather succinctly in this passage from the *Dialektik*:

So far as the relation between God and the world is concerned, there is in my view no identity, because the concept of world is a limit of thought but is not a transcendental Ground; rather the transcendental is always what I term God. But there is no separation in the sense that we could think God without thinking world, since only in the striving to complete the idea of the world do we come to the presupposition God.⁴⁵

Since God and world are correlative ideas, this accounts in large measure for Schleiermacher's apologetic, which sometimes gives the superficial appearance of pantheism. In his *Reden*, for example, he understood himself to be calling his Romantic friends to the awareness of the presuppositions of their own view that the world was an organic and unified whole.

Nevertheless, the accusation of pantheism is rooted in a legitimate uneasiness over Schleiermacher's handling of this theme. The problem is quite evident in his discussion of the doctrine of creation. There he argues that the feeling of absolute dependence, from which all other statements must be derived, can be broken down into two conceptions, creation and preservation. The chief purposes of the doctrine of creation, he maintains, are to point to the sole dependence of the world upon God and to prevent God from being placed under the antitheses of the finite causal order. But this doctrine not only lends itself to abuse, since it can be taken to mean that God is envisaged as one cause among others, it also is not directly related to the immediate self-consciousness, since nothing in our self-consciousness has to do with a past creation of the world. The doctrine of

creation, it turns out, serves primarily a negative rather than a positive function for Schleiermacher; that is, it safeguards the system of doctrine against any assertion that the world is self-existent. This purpose, however, could as easily have been served by the doctrine of preservation. It is not surprising, therefore, that Schleiermacher tends to subsume the former doctrine under the latter. The doctrine of divine preservation, however, simply states that all things "are conditioned and determined by the interdependence of nature" and thus does not sufficiently differentiate the divine causality from the causality of nature, or, to put the matter differently, God from the system of nature. Since the problem of God's transcendence is not solved by the doctrines of creation or preservation, therefore, Schleiermacher's interpretation of the other divine attributes becomes crucial so far as our understanding of the matter is concerned.

Four of the classical metaphysical attributes of God can be extrapolated from the feeling of absolute dependence. They are

1. God's eternity. This signifies "the absolutely timeless causality of God, which conditions not only all that is temporal, but time as well."⁴⁶
2. God's omnipresence. This signifies "the absolutely spaceless causality of God, which conditions not only all that is spatial, but space itself as well."⁴⁷
3. God's omnipotence. Two ideas are contained here: "first, that the entire system of Nature, comprehending all times and spaces, is founded upon divine causality, which as eternal and omnipresent is in contrast to all finite causality; and second, that the divine causality, as affirmed in our feeling of absolute dependence, is completely presented in the totality of finite being, and consequently everything for which there is a

causality in God happens and becomes real."⁴⁸

4. God's omniscience. This signifies "the absolute spirituality of the divine Omnipotence."⁴⁹

An inspection of the first two of these four attributes discloses that Schleiermacher primarily uses them, on the one hand, to contrast the system of natural causality with the divine causality, without permitting, on the other hand, the natural to be conceived without the divine. In this sense, he conceives the relationship between the first cause and the system of secondary causes quite traditionally, despite the use of idealistic categories. God is present to creatures "as the maintenance of things in their being and in their powers. Any other explanation would find it difficult to avoid the suspicion of a mixture of the divine being with the finite, and therefore a semblance of pantheism."⁵⁰

It is his discussion of the third attribute, omnipotence, that raises the most doubts concerning the adequacy of his conception of the divine transcendence. The first idea—that the entire system of nature, comprehending all times and spaces, is founded upon divine causality, which is in contrast to all finite causality—merely reiterates the distinction made in the discussion of eternity and omnipresence. The second idea, however, raises the profoundest problems so far as the transcendence of God is concerned: "the divine causality . . . is completely presented in the totality of finite being, and consequently everything for which there is a causality in God happens and becomes real."⁵¹ This suggests that God's creativity is, so to speak, completely exhausted in the totality of finite being. Transcendence

could only signify that God is the "depth" of the world.

At first glance it might appear that Schleiermacher simply rephrases the classical metaphysical notion of God as *actus purus*, pure actuality without potentiality. But this classical notion did not necessarily mean that all God's actuality was *manifested* or *exhausted* in the finite created order, although it could be argued that this is the logical consequence of such an idea. It served the function primarily of denying the possibility of change in the divine being. Schleiermacher, however, not only denies such change but also rejects any idea of a realm of possibility transcending actuality.⁵² Insofar as the idea of God's freedom implies such a realm of possibility, he rejects this idea as well. This difficulty is compounded by his view of the relationship of the divine will to the divine intellect. There, he argues,

the divine thinking is the same as the divine will, and omnipotence and omniscience are one and the same . . . this divine knowledge is recognized as the very productivity of God, the creative as well as the preservative. . . .⁵³

The identification of these two attributes, the divine will and the intellect, has always had a pernicious effect in Christian theology. It destroys quite thoroughly any conception of the divine freedom in relation to the created order and makes meaningless any theological use of analogies taken from personal existence for the purpose of illuminating transcendence. Barth has quite correctly pointed out the difficulties:

The badness of this view which arose in orthodoxy and came to completion in Schleiermacher's school consists directly in its dissolution of the distinction between God's ability

(*Können*) and his action (*Tun*) and thus destroys his freedom in his action. With that, the praiseworthiness of his acting as being his own (in distinction to all other events), . . . in freedom and love . . . is made impossible.⁵⁴

In short, insofar as freedom consists in the will's actualization of some possibilities entertained by the intellect, Schleiermacher is totally unable to speak of God as free. What God "knows," he "wills," and there is "nothing left in the divine knowledge to which there is no correlative in existence."⁵⁵ God's power and knowledge are identical. What does not occur in the finite order cannot really be said to have been possible. God is, so to speak, exhausted in and by his creation.

It might be claimed in Schleiermacher's defense that this is less a metaphysical statement about God than it is a statement about the limitations of our knowledge. In other words, these attributes of God are all to be prefaced with the silent qualification, "so far as our limited apprehension permits us to say." Schleiermacher, in fact, does make just such a qualification. He argues that there is simply no point of connection for making demands upon the divine causality which extend beyond the natural order embraced by the feeling of absolute dependence.⁵⁶ But this kind of defense of Schleiermacher is not fully convincing here. For the force of Schleiermacher's doctrine in this section rests on a full-scale rejection of the category of possibility as such,⁵⁷ and the question at issue is precisely whether he does, in fact, make demands upon the divine causality that extend beyond the natural order embraced by this feeling.

Given this rejection of possibility, it is not surprising that Schleiermacher's

concept of human freedom is also unsatisfactory. In the section discussing the autonomy of the network of secondary causes he writes, "if we could have taken into account for each point the influence of the whole system of interaction [of the finite order] we should then have had to say that what was not actual was also not possible within the system of nature."⁵⁸ Here it is not merely a case of stating, as some Calvinists have stated, that God, having perfect knowledge of the system of nature, foreknows what our actions will be—Schleiermacher rightly objects to this form of argument—it is, rather, that Schleiermacher rejects all analogies resting on the distinction between knowing and willing, because he shrewdly discerns that all knowledge inevitably presupposes an element of receptivity. To use the language of metaphysics: Knowledge is an internal relation for the subject that knows. Schleiermacher insists, on the contrary, that divine knowledge is "determining knowledge" (whatever that may mean) and that a specific form of existence follows necessarily from the intrinsic nature of the ground of being. In short, his position ultimately threatens even the reality of a relative freedom.

Schleiermacher is, naturally, reluctant to state this conclusion so baldly. It is not accidental, I think, that he attempts to redeem the situation in his discussion of the fourth attribute, divine omniscience. Fearful lest his conception of the divine causality be interpreted as a blind necessity, he argues that omniscience refers to the "absolute spirituality of the divine omnipotence." To use the language of the church: God is living and not a "lifeless and blind necessity";⁵⁹ otherwise,

he asks rhetorically, how could we stand in relation to him? But this belated correction, or qualification, cannot redeem the situation; it simply lays down a fog of rhetoric. What do the words "living" and "relation" mean? Schleiermacher has obliterated the notion of reciprocity and the concept of possibility, which is its counterpart. He has also rejected the Scholastic distinction between mediate and immediate knowledge,⁶⁰ which enabled the Scholastics to use the language of *actus purus* without taking its logic to the bitter end—the rejection of all personal analogies as an aid to understanding the complexity of the divine being.

It is not my primary purpose here, however, to discuss the adequacy, or lack of it, of Schleiermacher's metaphysics but to make the formal point that he is not entitled to this type of metaphysical judgment at all, especially in the light of his principle that the consciousness of God is given in the self-consciousness only with the consciousness of the world, and that no statement about God's being in himself, in distinction from statements about God as the absolute causality in and through the world, are to be permitted.⁶¹ His judgments and assertions about God go beyond the immediate awareness of the religious consciousness. It strains the limits of comprehension to argue that the theologian can pass from the immediate awareness of contingency to the speculative assertion that there is nothing possible except what is or will become actual. Schleiermacher, despite his avowed intention not to borrow from the speculative sphere, does so. It is not surprising, therefore, that his later discussion of the attributes of love and wisdom seems difficult to reconcile with

what he has said concerning the metaphysical attributes taken from the abstract religious consciousness. Even if these positions can be reconciled, the metaphysical attributes seem not to do justice to the concrete expressions of the Christian self-consciousness. Nor is it accidental that Schleiermacher tells us: "To attribute mercy to God is more appropriate to the language of preaching and poetry than to that of dogmatic theology."⁶²

IV

It is too simple to claim that all Schleiermacher's errors arise from an inconsistency in the application of a relational method. This hardly accounts for so rich and complex a writer. I have suggested only that his inconsistency accounts for the inadequacy of his doctrine of God. Whether a similar inconsistency exists or can explain the peculiar defects in his Christology would still have to be demonstrated. I have shown, however, the untenability of the argument to the effect that all the dire consequences of modernism, especially its failure to interpret properly God's transcendence, follow necessarily from Schleiermacher's point of departure. The fault lies not in his stated method but in his failure to follow it through consistently. To that degree, it is also unwarranted to conclude that the only direction in which modern Protestant theology can profitably move is away from Schleiermacher and in the direction of a fully "objectivistic" and "realistic" theology of revelation; in short, that the present situation requires, as Barth believes, a monumental counterachievement. For Schleiermacher's method is not a demonstrable failure; it still lies before our generation as an

unfulfilled possibility. Überweg's insight may yet prove to be prophetic: "Schleiermacher's system is far inferior in formal perfection to Hegel's or Herbart's, but it is free from many of their limitations, and in its still largely unfinished form is more capable than any other post-Kantian philosophy of such a development as might remedy the defects of other systems."⁶³

It is of more than passing interest, therefore, that Barth interprets Bultmann as the latest exponent of this method. For it can scarcely be denied that Bultmann's theology (in the narrow sense), his Christology, and his anthropology differ markedly in content and tone from Schleiermacher's. How is this possible if a commitment to the relational method necessarily leads to Schleiermacher's errors? Would a synthesis of the two constitute a new and impressive theological alternative?

Debates over method and concerning the proper directions for theology are, on the whole, unproductive; but the present discussion is more confused than it need be by virtue of a prevalent and widely accepted mythology used in interpreting Protestant thought since Luther. That mythology looks something like this: after the Reformers, Protestantism hardened into a scholasticism which proved quite unable to deal with the intellectual revolutions of the eighteenth and nineteenth centuries. Protestant liberalism responded to this challenge but so capitulated to the spirit of the new age—its immanentism, optimism, and anthropocentrism—that there was nothing distinctive left for Christianity to defend. Neo-orthodoxy, happily, rejected this optimism and immanentism while preserving what was best in liberalism, its

honesty and critical spirit. The neo-orthodox revolt was based on a rediscovery of the "strange new world within the Bible," the transcendence of God, the sinfulness of man, and the Reformation principle *sola fidei, sola gratia*.

There is, of course, much truth in this myth, but it can now be seen to be too simple and even misleading. As Barth has pointed out with considerably more insight than some of his followers, there is, in fact, a deep affinity between the so-called liberal school of Schleiermacher, Ritschl, and Herrmann and the young Luther and Melancthon.⁶⁴ The entire Schleiermacher-Ritschl-Herrmann line may be interpreted as an effort to think through in a radical and consistent fashion the doctrine of justification by faith alone as it was expressed in Melancthon's famous dictum "*hoc est Christum cognoscere, beneficia eius cognoscere*," where knowing Christ's benefits is contrasted with believing a theory about the mode of his incarnation. In other words, theological doctrines are attempts to express the relation between God and the self that is implicit in faith and are not to be understood apart from that relation as speculative statements about the nature of God, Christ, or the world. The Schleiermacher-Ritschl-Herrmann line, to which Bultmann must, in this sense, be added, explored with great thoroughness what this view of faith entailed for a generation that found it difficult to assent either to metaphysical assertions or to dubious historical narratives. They argued, in effect, that the believer is quite free inwardly from the heteronomous demand to accept such propositions as the condition for faith. Indeed, they maintained that faith is possible without such propositions, or

even if they are denied, a position fraught with the most radical implications. Believing is as much a work as acting. Valid faith cannot consist in the affirmation of propositions which are incomprehensible or against which one inwardly protests, for how can this save a man? Herrmann summarized the entire point of view when he wrote:

A word can only have the significance of a word of God for a man if it brings him to true self-reflection in his momentary situation. Every religious thought that is not intelligible to us in this fashion, remains alien to us, even though we deal it out defiantly as the expression of our own conviction and inflame our own imagination ever so warmly with it.⁶⁵

Barth is correct in viewing Bultmann as a continuation of this basic approach and in noting its continuity with the early Luther. Bultmann also identifies doctrinal statements, especially christological ones, as existential utterances of faith, as expressions of the religious self-consciousness. The force of his position is strengthened by his systematic appeal to the New Testament itself, especially Paul:

One could say that the doctrine of justification in Paul is his real christology, if "*hoc est Christum cognoscere, beneficia eius cognoscere*." It becomes quite clear in the doctrine of justification that christology does not consist in speculation about Christ's essence but in a proclamation about the Christ-event; and observation which properly understands this event is not speculative but self-reflective. It is a thinking-through of one's own new existence.⁶⁶

This view permits Bultmann to maintain the objectivity of the encounter with God while, in contrast to Barth, denying that this revelation can be the basis for an intellectual knowledge about the divine essential nature. Revelation is not directed to the theoretical

reason. It also enables him to insist that the christological titles in the New Testament are highly relative and historically conditioned attempts to express the existential significance of the Christ-event and are, therefore, to be understood functionally rather than metaphysically. It also accounts for his attitude toward biblical criticism, since faith *qua* faith cannot be dependent on the relative and changing results of historical research.

It is impossible to pursue this line of argument here. It need only be suggested that a revision of the standard mythology by which we seek to understand contemporary Protestant theology is required. Something in the situation makes it possible to draw a line

from the Reformers to Schleiermacher and from that "father of liberal Protestantism" to Bultmann. If this is so, then it is not altogether clear which contemporary theologians should be called neo-Reformation theologians and which should be called modernists, and it would be possible to forget these labels and to appreciate again the viability of Schleiermacher's basic method. It was not my purpose in this essay to establish new lines of historical connection, however. Rather, I have attempted to provide some data which might occasion a reappraisal of Schleiermacher, a "hero," as Barth calls him, "with which theology is seldom gifted."⁶⁷

NOTES

1. Karl Barth, *Die protestantische Theologie im 19. Jahrhundert: Ihre Vorgeschichte und ihre Geschichte* (2d ed.; Zollikon-Zürich: Evangelischer Verlag, 1952), chap. xi. Cf. the abridged English translation, *From Rousseau to Ritschl* (London: S.C.M. Press, Ltd., 1959), chap. viii.

2. Barth, *The Word of God and the Word of Man*, trans. Douglas Horton (New York: Harper Torchbooks, 1957), pp. 195-96.

3. Barth, *Die protestantische Theologie*, pp. 380-81. Cf. English ed., p. 308.

4. *Ibid.*, p. 380. Cf. Eng. ed., p. 307.

5. Barth, *Die kirchliche Dogmatik*, I/1 (Zollikon-Zürich: Evangelischer Verlag, 1944), p. 36.

6. Barth, *Die kirchliche Dogmatik*, IV/1 (Zollikon-Zürich: Evangelischer Verlag, 1953), Preface.

7. Friedrich Schleiermacher, *Der christliche Glaube nach den Grundsätzen der evangelischen Kirche im Zusammenhange dargestellt* (2 vols., 7th ed.; Berlin: Walter De Gruyter & Co., 1960), Sec. 50. Hereinafter, this work will be referred to as "*DcG.*," and the section numbers, which run consecutively throughout, will be cited instead of the page numbers. Unless otherwise noted, I have used the translation by H. R. Mackintosh and J. S. Stewart entitled *The Christian Faith* (Edinburgh: T. & T. Clark, 1948).

8. Hans W. Frei, "Niebuhr's Theological Background," in *Faith and Ethics: The Theology of H. Richard Niebuhr*, ed. Paul Ramsey (New

York: Harper & Bros., 1957), p. 43.

9. The phrase is Dietrich Bonhoeffer's. See his *Letters and Papers from Prison*, ed. Eberhard Bethge; trans. Reginald H. Fuller (London: S.C.M. Press, Ltd., 1953), p. 123.

10. H. Richard Niebuhr, *Meaning of Revelation* (New York: Macmillan Co., 1946), p. 8.

11. *Ibid.*, p. 24.

12. *Ibid.*, p. 27.

13. John Calvin, *The Institutes of the Christian Religion*, trans. John Allen (Philadelphia: Presbyterian Board of Christian Education, 1936), Vol. I, chap. ii.

14. *DcG.*, Sec. 172. 1.

15. *Ibid.*, Sec. 30.

16. *Ibid.*, Sec. 30. 2. In explaining why he has not followed the procedure of reducing conceptions of divine attributes and modes of action and utterances regarding the constitution to descriptions of human states, Schleiermacher argues that any such attempt would "be left isolated without any historical support" and, therefore, would not fulfil the purpose of dogmatics, because language about God and the world *has*, in fact, arisen in the life of the church (in hymns and rhetoric), and these expressions must be criticized by the theologian and their relationship to the religious consciousness clarified. "Hence a work which at the present time tried to confine itself entirely to the proper fundamental form would have no link with the past, and just for

that reason would be of little practical use, either for purging the doctrinal system of alien elements, or for maintaining the clarity and verity of the rhetorical and poetic communications" (Sec. 30. 3). This defense scarcely allays the suspicion that Schleiermacher would have liked to have reduced all theological statements to descriptions of human states and justifies, to an extent, the argument that his approach is basically subjectivistic. But it must not be forgotten that Schleiermacher states in the immediately succeeding section that any self-consciousness points back to a determinant outside of it; in short, that feelings refer to something *extra nos*.

17. *Ibid.*, Sec. 5. 1. Schleiermacher employs at least three different sets of categories in explaining his view, and the relationship between them is not always clear. The first set consists of "feeling," "knowing," and "doing," where feeling is something underlying knowing and doing and not merely a psychological state alongside of these (Sec. 3). The second set consists of "activity" (*Selbsttätigkeit*) and "receptivity" (*Empfänglichkeit*), a "being" (*Sein*) and a "having-by-some-means-come-to-be" (*Irgendwiegewordensein*) (Sec. 4. 1). The third set consists of the names given to the various levels of consciousness: the lowest, animal-like (*tierartig*), the sensible (*sinnlich*), and the feeling of absolute dependence (Sec. 5). I have primarily employed the latter two sets in my own exposition of his views.

18. *Ibid.*, Sec. 5. 1.

19. *Ibid.*, Sec. 4. 1.

20. *Ibid.* (translation mine).

21. *Ibid.*, Sec. 5. 1.

22. *Ibid.*, Sec. 4. 4.

23. *Ibid.*, Sec. 34.

24. *Ibid.*, Sec. 5. 4.

25. *Ibid.*, Sec. 10. Cf. Sec. 62. 3.

26. *Ibid.*, Sec. 32. 1.

27. *On Religion: Speeches to its Cultured Despisers*, trans. John Oman with an Introduction by Rudolf Otto (New York: Harper Torchbooks, 1958), p. 61. This proposition sounds more subjectivistic and agnostic than corresponding ones in the first edition of 1799, in which Schleiermacher made a consistent distinction between intuition (*Anschauung*) and feeling (*Gefühl*). In the 1799 edition, "intuition" refers to a kind of awareness of the nature of things that impinge upon the subject, although it does not permit him to make a metaphysical statement about this nature apart from its operation upon the subject. (Cf. *Über die Religion: Reden an die Gebildeten unter ihren Verächtern* [Hamburg: Felix Meiner Verlag, 1958], p. 31.) Feeling, in the first edition, arises from intuition. Each intuition has its correlative feeling or pattern of feelings and the kind of intuition determines the type and degree of the accompanying feeling (*ibid.*, p. 37). Intui-

tion without feeling is nothing, just as feeling without intuition is also nothing (*ibid.*, p. 41). The primal origin of all true religion is that mysterious and indescribable moment when intuition and feeling are undivided and one in the deepest core of the self (*ibid.*, pp. 41-42).

Schleiermacher's views developed between the first edition of 1799 and the second of 1806, particularly concerning the relationship of intuition to feeling. Richard Brandt argues that Schleiermacher intended to drop the use of intuition altogether and did so in the revised form of the second and third speeches but that he apparently had no time to complete the revision of the others and merely substituted, without bothering to alter the context, the words "feeling" or "view" or "idea" wherever the word "intuition" appeared. (See Brandt's *The Philosophy of Schleiermacher: The Development of His Theory of Scientific and Religious Knowledge* [New York: Harper & Bros., 1941], pp. 175-84.) Whether or not this is so, one could argue that the second and third editions of the *Reden* are actually less satisfactory than the first from an epistemological point of view. In the first, intuition is a type of cognitive awareness, and theology is to be interpreted as a clarification of the intuitions. In the second and third editions, on the other hand, theology is twice-removed, so to speak, from its "object" because it is a description of the feelings which are in turn concomitants of an intuition. But it must be remembered that Schleiermacher extended the concept of feeling in the later editions to incorporate some of the functions previously designated by the term intuition, although one cannot commend him for his precision in this respect.

28. Brandt, *op. cit.*, pp. 291-92.

29. Cf. Karl Jaspers' position in *Way to Wisdom: An Introduction to Philosophy*, trans. Ralph Manheim (New Haven, Conn.: Yale University Press, 1951), chap. iv.

30. Friedrich Schleiermacher, *Sämmtliche Werke*, Part III, Vol. 4, Part 2 (Berlin: G. Reimer, 1839).

31. *Ibid.*, paragraph 136, p. 77.

32. I believe it is quite clear that the ideas of world and of God are correlative but not identical ideas in the *Dialektik*. Both are, to use the Kantian terminology, transcendental ideas, but they function in somewhat different ways. Schleiermacher wrote: "in thought the divine is viewed as a unity without multiplicity, while the world is viewed as multiplicity without unity; the world is realized in space and time, the divine is spaceless and timeless; the world is the totality of oppositions, the divine is the real negation of all opposition" (*ibid.*, pp. 162 ff.). Or again: "as the idea of divinity is, transcendently, *terminus a quo* and the principle of the possibility of knowledge as such; so the idea of world is, transcendently, *terminus ad quem* and the principle of

knowledge in its development" (*ibid.*, p. 164).

33. *DcG.*, Sec. 32.

34. In the *Reden*, Schleiermacher appeared, to many readers, to have identified God and the nature-system. This appearance arises from a failure to see that God and world are correlative but not identical ideas and that the former can only arise as a concomitant of the latter. In a corrective note to the last edition, he wrote: "What, however, has struck most readers is that the Infinite Existence does not appear to be the Highest Being as cause of the World but the World itself. I do not think God can be placed in such a relation as cause, and I leave you to say whether the World can be conceived as a true All and Whole without God" (*On Religion*, p. 103).

35. *Dialektik*, p. 322.

36. *The Mediator: A Study of the Central Doctrine of the Christian Faith*, trans. Olive Wyon (Philadelphia: Westminster Press, 1947), p. 51.

37. *DcG.*, Sec. 53. 1.

38. See especially the interpretation of Philip Watson in *Let God Be God: An Interpretation of the Theology of Martin Luther* (London: Epworth Press, 1947), p. 163.

39. *DcG.*, Sec. 46. 2.

40. Barth, *Die kirchliche Dogmatik*, II/1 (Zollikon-Zürich: Evangelischer Verlag, 1946), p. 381.

41. *DcG.*, Sec. 32. 2. The feeling of relative freedom remains because the feeling of absolute dependence does not annul the feelings of relative freedom and dependence of the sensible self-consciousness. In his handwritten notes, which occur in the notes of the new critical edition of the *Glaubenslehre*, Schleiermacher made quite clear that the feeling of absolute dependence does not compete with the feelings of relative freedom and dependence. (See especially Vol. I, p. 27, n. 3. Cf. also p. 31, n. 1.)

42. Charles Hartshorne, *The Divine Relativity: A Social Conception of God* (New Haven, Conn.: Yale University Press, 1948), pp. 67 ff.

43. Barth, *Die kirchliche Dogmatik*, II/1, pp. 594-98.

44. *DcG.*, Sec. 51 and Sec. 32. 2.

45. *Dialektik*, p. 256.

46. *Ibid.*, Sec. 52.

47. *Ibid.*, Sec. 53.

48. *Ibid.*, Sec. 54.

49. *Ibid.*, Sec. 55.

50. *Ibid.*, Sec. 53. 2.

51. *Ibid.*, Sec. 54.

52. *Ibid.*, Sec. 55. 2.

53. *Ibid.*, Sec. 55. 1.

54. Barth, *Die kirchliche Dogmatik*, II/1, p. 597.

55. *DcG.*, Sec. 55. 1.

56. *Ibid.*, Sec. 54. 2.

57. *Ibid.*, Sec. 55. 2.

58. *Ibid.*, Sec. 54. 2.

59. *Ibid.*, Sec. 55. 1.

60. *Ibid.*, Sec. 55. 2.

61. See n. 14 above.

62. *Ibid.*, Sec. 85.

63. Quoted by John Oman in his Introduction to *On Religion* (London: Kegan Paul, Trench, Trubner & Co. Ltd., 1893), p. xi.

64. Karl Barth, *Rudolf Bultmann: Ein Versuch, ihn zu verstehen* (Zollikon-Zürich: Evangelischer Verlag, 1952), p. 46. Significantly, Barth notes that Herrmann, Ritschl, and Kierkegaard were "also good Lutherans" (p. 47) and adds that the great interest in the Reformation shaped by the work of Karl Holl was of no fundamental interest to him. "Luther, especially, stood quite far from me at that time" (p. 10).

65. Willhem Herrmann, *Gesammelte Aufsätze*, ed. F. W. Schmidt (Tübingen: J. C. B. Mohr, 1923), p. 12.

66. Rudolf Bultmann, *Glauben und Verstehen* (Tübingen: J. C. B. Mohr, 1933), I, 262.

67. Barth, *Die protestantische Theologie*, p. 380. Cf. English ed., p. 308.